

# SURENDRA KURELLA



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Dynamic and results-oriented Technical Program Delivery Manager + Release Train Engineer with 10+ years of experience in Agile software development environments and overall IT experience of 19+ years. Skilled in facilitating Agile Release Trains (ARTs), coordinating cross-functional teams, and driving continuous improvement. Seeking a challenging role to leverage expertise in Agile methodologies, Scrum practices, and stakeholder management to streamline release processes and deliver high-quality software products.



## PROFILE SUMMARY

- ❖ Visionary IT leader with over 19 years demonstrated excellence in driving large complex business driven IT programs with budget spanning up to **\$15M**.
- ❖ **Experience in facilitating Agile Release Trains (ARTs)** consisting of multiple Agile teams, ensuring alignment with business objectives and delivery of value to customers.
- ❖ **Driven coordination** with Product Managers, Product Owners, Scrum Masters, and other stakeholders to prioritize features, define program increments, and establish release timelines.
- ❖ **Conducted Program Increment (PI) Planning** events, facilitating cross-team collaboration, dependency management, and resolution of impediments.
- ❖ **Led ART ceremonies** including scrum of scrums, system demos, and retrospectives to promote transparency, alignment, and continuous improvement.
- ❖ **Managed risks and issues** using JIRA RAID process, escalating as necessary to drive timely resolution and minimize project impacts.
- ❖ **Implemented Agile best practices**, metrics, and tools to track progress, measure performance, and drive process improvements.
- ❖ **Mentored and coached** Agile teams and stakeholders on Agile principles, practices, and frameworks.
- ❖ Fostered a culture of innovation and continuous improvement within the engineering team.
- ❖ **Developed and maintained** project plans, schedules, and budgets, tracking progress and managing risks to meet project milestones and deliverables.
- ❖ **Synchronized with multiple teams** including engineering, product management, sales, and operations to prioritize tasks, allocate resources, and resolve dependencies.
- ❖ **Collaborated with cross-functional teams** to define the **architecture roadmap** and establish architectural standards for numerous programs in Banking, Retirements.
- ❖ **Strong problem solving & consulting skills** coupled with confident decision making for enabling effective solutions leading to high customer satisfaction and low operational costs.
- ❖ **Solid technical background** with experience of executing roles such as technical lead, solutions architect. Good understanding of microservices, micro-frontends architectural patterns.
- ❖ **Extensive hands-on experience** in cloud computing specializing in public clouds such as GCP, AWS and private clouds like IBM Aurora.
- ❖ Steered Engagement planning **including RFPs, RFIs, proposals & client meetings**, while managing complete portfolio of projects including budgeting, planning, vendor approval.
- ❖ Wide exposure to handling Devops teams and **service delivery operations** using ITIL framework, ensuring high levels of customer satisfaction and operational efficiency. Deployed support teams to operate in 24\*7 model to assure compliance with defined KPIs, SLAs. Well versed with incident, problem, change management.
- ❖ **Strong grasp of data lake architecture**, data warehousing concepts including tools such as Teradata, Talend.
- ❖ **Extensive digital transformation background** including delivering B2B, B2C offerings in retirements, banking, and insurance domains. Familiarity in content management systems such as Drupal, AEM.
- ❖ Recognized for deploying **generative AI** technologies such as GitHub Copilot to reduce time to market for new products.
- ❖ Functional Knowledge of ServiceNow ITSM for incident, problem, change record management. Conversant with CMDB, report generation, client and server-side scripting.

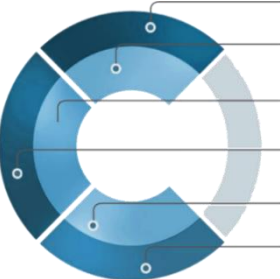


## CORE COMPETENCIES

- |                                    |                                  |                                               |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| ➤ Program/ Project Management      | ➤ Strategy & Roadmap Development | ➤ Client/ Stakeholder Relationship Management |
| ➤ Global Delivery Management       | ➤ Budgeting & Cost Control       | ➤ Agile/ Scrum Methodologies                  |
| ➤ Business Process Re- engineering | ➤ Solution Architecture          | ➤ Team Building & Leadership                  |



## SOFT SKILLS



- Analytical & Problem-solving
- High Business Ethics
- Positive Attitude
- Organizer & Motivator
- Communication & Collaboration
- Decision-making & Visionary



## EDUCATION



MCA [Masters in Computer Applications] from Vellore Institute of Technology, with CGPA 8.66/10



B.Sc. [Maths Hons.] ] from University of Delhi, with 60.0%



## CERTIFICATION

- ❖ PMI-ACP certified.
- ❖ SAFE 5 certified



TECHNICAL SKILLS

- ❖ **Project Management:** Jira, Confluence, MS Office – Excel, PowerPoint, Visio, Microsoft Project, ITIL
- ❖ **SDLC Methodologies:** Scrum, Kanban, XP, SAFE5, Scrumban, Waterfall, DevSecOps, Devops
- ❖ **Monitoring Tools:** Splunk Enterprise, Splunk ITSI, Dynatrace
- ❖ **Analytics Tools:** AWS Quicksight, Tableau
- ❖ **CI/CD/CM/AI/Other Tools:** Integrated development platform, Jenkins, Spinnaker, Gitlab Ultimate, GitHub Copilot
- ❖ **Source Management Tools:** Git, GitHub, Bitbucket
- ❖ **Container Management:** Docker, Kubernetes
- ❖ **Ticketing Tools:** Jira, ServiceNow, AXIS BMC Remedy Tool
- ❖ **Scripting Language:** YAML, Shell Scripts, Terraform
- ❖ **Databases:** Db2, Oracle, SQL server, Teradata, Red Shift
- ❖ **Mainframe:** JCL, DB2, CICS, Cobol, IMS DB, IMS DC, Easytrieve, PL1
- ❖ **API Tools:** SOAP UI, POSTMAN
- ❖ **Operating Systems:** Linux, Windows, zOS
- ❖ **Cloud- GCP:** GCP-GKE, App Engine, Compute Engine, Cloud Storage, Cloud SQL, Cloud Spanner, Bigtable, Apigee, VPC, Subnets, Firestore, Datastore, Apigee, Docker, Containers, IAM, Cloud Monitoring and operations, Cloud Run
- ❖ **Cloud- AWS:** EC2, Cloudwatch, Redshift DB, S3 object storage, Lambda event triggers, EBS block storage, Glacier, Route 53 DNS, VPC, ELB, Quicksight, FSX, Postgre SQL
- ❖ **Languages:** C++, Java, Angular, HTML, CSS, Javascript



WORK EXPERIENCE

Apr’22- Present | Infosys Ltd., Bangalore | Principal Consultant, Technical Program Delivery Manager

Client: Vanguard, USA | Program: Plan Admin Plan Health

Key Result Areas:

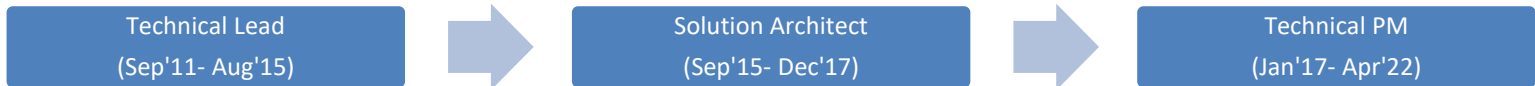
- ❖ Steered multi-million-dollar AWS digital transformation journey from mainframe for the retirement provider Vanguard using Scrum/SAFE delivery model.
- ❖ Led requirements discovery sessions and architecture workshops to build the E2E architecture spanning all the layers and systems involved.
- ❖ Spearheaded PI Planning, sprint reviews, sprint pre-planning, PI retrospectives as a release train engineer (RTE) in conjunction to program manager.
- ❖ Established and led 15+ scrum cross-functional teams with more than 150+ team members across distributed locations to deliver program backlogs.
- ❖ Conducted scrum of scrums, agile ceremonies for scrum teams as necessary, worked with product managers to define vision and product roadmap.
- ❖ Created the microservices definitions for capabilities across 4 tracks, defined services for asynchronous file upload/download using a generic pattern.
- ❖ Identified data lake strategy, ingestion pattern for the data and defined the data attributes of genome models to design custom analytics dashboards.
- ❖ Steered the migration of 9 standard analytics dashboards from Tableau to AWS Quicksight. Also, conducted the data mapping, modeling exercise to ingest and transform the data attributes needed from S3 bucket.
- ❖ Managed all client reporting, including weekly status reports, sprint pre-planning decks, and dependency tracking updates.
- ❖ Conducted workshops to embed appropriate UI/UX and responsive design principles in the UI.
- ❖ Handled Risk, Change, Release and Delivery Management including service operations to ensure compliance with KPIs, SLAs.
- ❖ Deployed Github copilot across the program resulting in **savings of 20% coding effort** and quick turnaround time to market.

Highlights:

- ❖ Achieving CMMi Level 4 compliance for the teams in the program, marking a significant milestone in process maturity.
- ❖ Rollout of modernized B2B, B2C user experiences for Vanguard participants and customers
- ❖ Delivering a value of more than **15 million USD** with 95% customer satisfaction rate.

Sep’11- Apr’22 | Wipro Technologies Ltd., Bangalore

Growth Path:



Projects:

Jan’21- Apr’22 | Fusion | Client: Cynergy Bank, UK | Location: Bangalore | Role: Technical Program Delivery Manager

Roles & Responsibilities:

- ❖ Led the bank’s digital transformation, migrating legacy applications on mainframe to cloud-hosted apps in GCP.
- ❖ Delivered multiple large-scale initiatives leveraging Microservices, GCP, Angular, Salesforce technologies with value of up to **\$10M**
- ❖ Acted as a Release Train Engineer, coordinated PI planning, and ensured UI/UX principles in design.
- ❖ Drove project implementations, tracked corporate website and nCino loan origination projects for on-time delivery.
- ❖ Collaborated on seamless single sign-on solution with digital security, Enterprise architects, and Azure AD.
- ❖ Outlined the post-migration operating model and coordinated operational acceptance testing.

- ❖ Ensured successful functioning of online, mobile channels, and corporate website post-migration.
- ❖ Fore fronted service operations establishing required Devops teams to handle production fixes and incidents.

**Jun’20- Dec’20 | New Payments Architecture | Client: Lloyds Banking Group, UK | Location: London, UK & Bangalore | Role: Technical Program Delivery Manager**

**Roles & Responsibilities:**

- ❖ Led the transition of faster payments/BACS traffic from monolithic applications on mainframe, Tandem to microservices and a cloud SaaS gateway.
- ❖ Designed microservices, hosted them on IBM Container Platform short-term, with eventual migration to Google Cloud Platform.
- ❖ Collaborated with Form3 to deploy SaaS services on GCP, replacing the existing gateway for faster payment schemes.
- ❖ Implemented monitoring for 10+ microservices using Splunk, resulting in an **additional revenue of £1.5 million per year**.
- ❖ Developed a Splunk dashboard delivery plan aligned with microservices and SaaS gateway testing. Provisioned E2E Kafka architecture for data ingestion into microservices and Splunk.
- ❖ Worked in a SAFE-based delivery model, leading PI planning workshops and coordinating as a release train engineer.
- ❖ Executed service transition plan to operations team in a phased manner ensuring minimal risk to production service and compliance to agreed KPIs, SLAs for faster/BACS payments.

**Jan’20- May’20 | Cash Management Program | Client: Lloyds Banking Group, UK | Location: London, UK | Role: Technical Program Delivery Manager**

**Roles & Responsibilities:**

- ❖ Conducted design workshops with SMEs and architects to identify legacy platform functionality for migration to a new cloud-based stack.
- ❖ Adopted SAFE-based delivery, led BA team in documenting requirements, created user personas, and addressed monitoring needs.
- ❖ Managed client expectations, created estimates, project plan, and schedule, overseeing resource allocation. Identified API proxies for GCP Apigee hosting, devised migration strategy considering associated risks and crafted phase-wise release plans and wireframes for payment initiation channels.
- ❖ Ensured timely project completion resulting in **manual processes costing \$500K every year** to be automated and resulting in further cost savings for the customer.

**Jan’19- Dec’19 | Payments SEML | Client: Lloyds Banking Group, UK | Location: London, UK & Bangalore | Role: Service Delivery Manager**

**Roles & Responsibilities:**

- ❖ **Managed Change, Incident, Problem, Capacity, Patch, and Compliance Management** in alignment with agreed SLAs. Provided guidance to project teams, ensuring high-quality deliverables within time and budget constraints.
- ❖ Led and actively participated in war room sessions during critical incidents, providing leadership and guidance to cross-functional teams to resolve issues swiftly and minimize downtime.
- ❖ Coordinated with technical teams, stakeholders, and senior management to assess the impact of incidents, prioritize actions, and drive resolution efforts.
- ❖ Facilitated communication and collaboration between internal teams and external partners/vendors to ensure alignment and effective incident response.
- ❖ Implemented incident management best practices and established protocols for escalation, communication, and post-incident review to improve response capabilities and prevent recurrence.
- ❖ Managed stakeholder expectations, provided regular updates on incident status and progress towards resolution, and addressed concerns to maintain trust and transparency.
- ❖ Conducted post-incident reviews to identify root causes, lessons learned, and opportunities for process improvements, driving continuous enhancement of incident management practices.
- ❖ Managed Business Continuity/DR plans, implementing backup/recovery strategies with clear RPOs and RTOs. Directed resolution of high-critical issues on war-room calls by engaging relevant parties.
- ❖ Led the implementation of Scrumban teams to drive fixes for production issues in conjunction to handling day to day incidents and operational issues.
- ❖ Conducted performance reviews, development plans, and prioritized goals for 8 direct reports, with significant input into 80+ indirect reports.
- ❖ Steered the contract discussions for shared services and ensured revenue of more than **USD 8M** every year.

**Jan’17- Dec’18 | Straight Through- International Payments | Client: Lloyds Banking Group, UK | Location: London, UK | Role: Technical Project Manager**

**Roles & Responsibilities:**

- ❖ Leading multiple legal, regulatory, mandatory projects including – Swift Standards 2017/2018, Ring Fenced Banking. Swift GPI, PSD2, EUPAD each having budget between 1 to 10 million pounds
- ❖ In conjunction to the above also steered the faster payments gateway migration project which was a major technology transformation initiative
- ❖ Defined the E2E architecture and constructed the high/low level designs based on business requirements
- ❖ Prepared project plan capturing various milestones for build, unit, system, integration testing along with go live
- ❖ Fixed complex issues by assisting developers identify potential solution and steer the testing

- ❖ Coordinated environment bookings, clash management for the releases, release management and change management
- ❖ Facilitated transition to run team post closure of the warranty period by actively closing any issues from warranty
- ❖ Cover DR, cutover events, along with operational testing based on the project GoLive date
- ❖ Production/maintenance of GAP analysis, RAIDs, Matrices, Mandates, PID's, Risk registers, Issue/daily logs
- ❖ Development of ITSM ITIL processes, Risk Register, BCP with RPO/RTO

**Sep'11- Dec'16 | Online Customer Information System | Client: Lloyds Banking Group, UK | Location: UK & Bangalore | Role: Solution Architect, Tech Lead**

**Roles & responsibilities:**

- ❖ Steering solutions for numerous projects of importance including Inter party relationships, P2P, TSB Separation, Product Status, Galaxy paperless, Customer Banking Online amongst others.
- ❖ Coordinating the impact analysis of the portfolio to identify the project impacts and the planning design based on the impacted systems.
- ❖ Pursuing tactical, strategic solutions in parallel thereby creating innovative solution to reduce interim customer impact
- ❖ Coaching, mentoring team members, reviewing the deliverables from build , testing, signing off the system, integration testing from platform perspective
- ❖ Preparing system maintenance technical design documents, knowledge articles for support handover
- ❖ Technical authority for business, aligning all IT Service & Project elements to IT & Business strategy.

**PREVIOUS EXPERIENCE**

**May'10- Aug'11 | Mphasis (A HP Company), Chennai | Module Lead**

**Nov'08- Apr'10 | Computer Science Corporation, Chennai | Software Engineer**

**Feb'05- Oct'08 | Tata Consultancy Services, Chennai | Assistant System Engineer**



**PERSONAL DETAILS**

- ❖ **Date of Birth:** 6<sup>th</sup> August 1979
- ❖ **Languages Known:** English, Hindi, Telugu
- ❖ **Address:** Flat No. 218, Celebrity Classic Doddathogur Village Electronic City- 560100, Bengaluru

